

list of operating systems'. If you dual boot with another OS, reduce the amount of time for which the boot options are displayed. Thus, when you switch on your PC, you will not have to hang around to press [Enter] to load Windows.

### Automatic Logon

If yours is a single-user PC, or a particular user logs on to Windows 2000 most often, you can have the operating system logon automatically with that user's credentials. You should not use this if security is a concern. If the computer is part of a workgroup and not logging on to a domain, open **Control Panel > Users and Passwords** and uncheck 'Users must enter a user name and password to use this computer'. On the Advanced tab, uncheck 'Require users to press Ctrl-Alt-Del before logging on'.

If Windows is set to log on to a domain, you can enable this functionality by editing the registry. Start regedt32 from **Start > Run** and navigate to HKEY\_Local\_Machine\Software\Microsoft\WindowsNT\CurrentVersion\Winlogon. Create the keys DefaultDomainName, DefaultUserName, and DefaultPass-



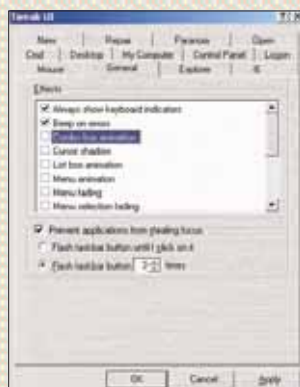
Log on automatically to Windows 2000

word and enter the domain, user name and password to automatically log on to.

### Using Tweak UI for Windows 2000

Tweak UI for Windows 2000 is a very powerful tool to modify system settings. Though the installer is the same one as for Windows 98, the options available and its behaviour are different in several respects. On installing Tweak UI, you can launch it from the Control Panel.

On the General tab, turn off Combo box animation,



Tweak UI for Windows 2000

Cursor shadow, List box animation, Menu animation, Menu fading, Menu selection fading, Smooth scrolling, Tooltip animation, Tooltip fade and Window animation. Switch to the IE tab and uncheck the box to 'Allow Active Desktop to be turned on/off'. On the Paranoia tab you can disable Autorun for audio and data CDs.

Options on the Cmd tab let you configure keys to automatically complete file and directory names at the Com-

mand Prompt. For example, you can type in the first character of the file or directory name and press Tab to have Windows fill in the rest for you. This is extremely useful even if you work only occa-



## WINDOWS XP PROFESSIONAL

### XP is quite user-friendly with an impressive interface, but is sluggish on low-end systems

### Change the theme

The default Windows XP theme looks very pretty, but hogs a lot of system resources for the eye-candy effects such as bevelled objects and transitions. If looks are not important to you, switch over to the classic Windows look. To do this, right-click an empty area

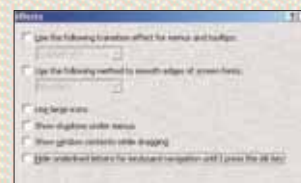


Switch to the classic Windows theme

of the desktop and click Properties. Under the Themes tab, set Windows Classic as the current theme and click OK.

### Turn off display effects

Switching off transition and animation effects can save a lot of system resources. These effects are not required to run programs and cause an unnecessary load on the



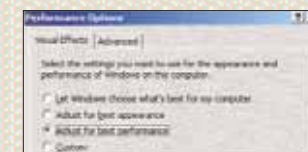
Disable all display effects on XP

with the Command Prompt. On the Logon tab, you can set an account to automatically log on after booting Windows. This is useful for single-user PCs, or where security is not critical.

processor and RAM. Right-click on an empty area of the desktop, click Properties and switch to the Appearance tab. Click Effects and clear all the checkboxes.

### Choose performance

Windows XP has some very good features to maximise performance. Unfortunately, the default settings are no good. You can choose to have it optimise itself for faster computing. To change these settings, click Start, right-click My Computer and click Properties. Switch to the Advanced tab and click the Settings button under Performance. By default, 'Let Windows choose what's best for my computer' is selected. Choose 'Adjust for best performance' instead, and you will almost immediately notice a boost in speed. This is because all graphic effects are turned off. You can



XP lets you optimise the OS for performance